A good example here is Vijayanagar's very Persianate courtly attire: *kabayi*, 'a long-sleeved pullover tunic with front slit', and *kullayi*, 'a high, brimless conical cap with rounded top'. This was in sharp contrast to the attire of other Hindu kings in south India, who, as Razzaq observes, went 'as naked as other Hindus', donning merely a loincloth. Wagoner argues that 'the minimal dress of South Indian rulers would have appeared immodest and barbaric' by Persianate cultural standards. In a bid to be taken seriously by Muslim royalty of north India and West Asia (via traders and envoys), Vijayanagar's elites adopted a style of dress closer to Persianate 'norms of modesty and public decorum'.

Such ready embrace of Persianate culture was voluntary, writes Wagoner (he uses 'Islamicate' to mean the same thing), and went beyond 'the material culture of the court' to cover 'military technology and strategy, political and administrative institutions' as well as architecture. Indeed, 'metropolitan Vijayanagara, especially the Royal Center, is saturated with Persian architectural elements: domes, vaulted arches, parapets of merlons, corner finials, fine plasterwork, and so forth'—evident in the Queen's Bath, the Elephant Stables, the Lotus Mahal and other buildings in the mislabelled 'Zenana Enclosure'.[28] Wagoner adds that this cultural mingling 'unfolded not as some inevitable consequence of "the onslaught of Islam," but quite the opposite, as the result of conscious and deliberately calculated acts by creative individuals seeking to maximize their opportunities in an ever-widening world'. Of course, as in the Sultanate of Bijapur, syncretic cultural diffusion went both ways with elite Muslims adopting Hindu arts, such as in styles of depicting human figures in paintings.[29] Historian William Dalrymple writes that Bijapur's sultan, Ibrahim Adil Shahi II, 'visited both Shaivite temples and the monasteries of the Nath yogis, and knew Sanskrit better than Persian'.[30]

Wandering the Royal Centre, it occurs to me that perhaps another Persianate cultural import in Vijayanagar was its constraints on courtly women. Other south Indian kings, half-naked in their loincloths, didn't confine their 'royal queens and female family members' in 'segregated and strictly guarded zones' within walled compounds. In contrast, the royal women of Vijayanagar, watched over by eunuchs and carried in closed palanquins, were given no role in public life and couldn't even be seen by